

26STCV03340 26STCV03340

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Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 517

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The Court is granting Defendant Mercedes-Benz USA LLC's motion to compel arbitration of the Plaintiffs' claims against it in this action for breach of the express and implied warranties associated with a motor vehicle that Mercedes distributed and that the Plaintiffs leased from a Mercedes dealership. Mercedes's motion is based on an arbitration provision in the lease between the Plaintiffs and the dealership. Mercedes is expressly named in the lease as a third-party beneficiary of the arbitration provision. Mercedes has standing to enforce the arbitration provision under the standards for determining third-party beneficiary status set forth in *Goonewardene v. ADP, LLC* (2019) 6 Cal.5th 817, 830.) Plaintiffs' reliance on the *Ford Motor Warranty Cases* (2025) 17 Cal.5th 1122 to defeat Mercedes's motion is misplaced. The *Ford Motor Warranty Cases* did not involve an arbitration provision in which the party seeking to enforce it was expressly named in it as a third-party beneficiary.

In light of the Court's decision granting Mercedes's motion, this action is stayed pending completion of the arbitration. The case management conference on calendar today is vacated. The Court is setting a hearing on the status of the arbitration for July 29, 2027 at 8:30 a.m.